MIL-I-14653
29 August 1986
SUPERSEDING
MIL-I-3037G(IN PART)
30 September 1981

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA, EMBROIDERED FLAG COMPONENTS, GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the Schiffli machine embroidered flag blank components for some military flags.

1.2 Classification. The embroidered flag components covered by this specification shall be of the following types, styles and classes.

Type I - Embroidered components for Army organizational flag blank.

Style 1 - Eagle's Wing, Right
Style 2 - Eagle's Wing, Left
Style 3 - Eagle's Head, Right
Style 4 - Eagle's Head, Left
Style 5 - Eagle's Tail Feathers
Style 6 - Eagle's Claws and Arrows, Right

Class 1 - Yellow HH, Cable No. 67108
Class 2 - Scarlet HL, Cable No. 67111
Class 3 - Flag Blue HY, Cable No. 67124
Class 4 - Green HAD, Cable No. 67129
Class 5 - Crimson HM, Cable No. 67112
Class 6 - Buff HAK, Cable No. 67135
Class 7 - Orange HK, Cable No. 67110
Class 8 - Brick Red HN, Cable No. 67113
Class 9 - Teal Blue HV, Cable No. 67121
Class 10 - Oriental Blue HBW, Cable No. 67172
Class 11 - Ultramarine Blue HS, Cable No. 67118
Class 12 - Bottle Green HCQ, Cable No. 67191
Class 13 - Maroon HO, Cable No. 67114

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8455
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Style 7 - Eagle's Claws and Arrows, Left

Class 1 - Yellow HH, Cable No. 67108
Class 2 - Scarlet HL, Cable No. 67111
Class 3 - Flag Blue HY, Cable No. 67124
Class 4 - Green HAD, Cable No. 67129
Class 5 - Crimson HM, Cable No. 67112
Class 6 - Buff HAK, Cable No. 67135
Class 7 - Orange HK, Cable No. 67110
Class 8 - Brick Red HN, Cable No. 67113
Class 9 - Teal Blue HV, Cable No. 67121
Class 10 - Oriental Blue HBW, Cable No. 67172
Class 11 - Ultramarine Blue HS, Cable No. 67118
Class 12 - Bottle Green HCQ, Cable No. 67191
Class 13 - Maroon HO, Cable No. 67114

Style 8 - Eagle's Claws and Olive Branch, Right

Class 1 - Yellow HH, Cable No. 67108
Class 2 - Scarlet HL, Cable No. 67111
Class 3 - Flag Blue HY, Cable No. 67124
Class 4 - Green HAD, Cable No. 67129
Class 5 - Crimson HM, Cable No. 67112
Class 6 - Buff HAK, Cable No. 67135
Class 7 - Orange HK, Cable No. 67110
Class 8 - Brick Red HN, Cable No. 67113
Class 9 - Teal Blue HV, Cable No. 67121
Class 10 - Oriental Blue HBW, Cable No. 67172
Class 11 - Ultramarine Blue HS, Cable No. 67118
Class 12 - Bottle Green HCQ, Cable No. 67191
Class 13 - Maroon HO, Cable No. 67114

Style 9 - Eagle's Claws and Olive Branch, Left

Class 1 - Yellow HH, Cable No. 67108
Class 2 - Scarlet HL, Cable No. 67111
Class 3 - Flag Blue HY, Cable No. 67124
Class 4 - Green HAD, Cable No. 67129
Class 5 - Crimson HM, Cable No. 67112
Class 6 - Buff HAK, Cable No. 67135
Class 7 - Orange HK, Cable No. 67110
Class 8 - Brick Red HN, Cable No. 67113
Class 9 - Teal Blue HV, Cable No. 67121
Class 10 - Oriental Blue HBW, Cable No. 67172
Class 11 - Ultramarine Blue HS, Cable No. 67118
Class 12 - Bottle Green HCQ, Cable No. 67191
Class 13 - Maroon HO, Cable No. 67114

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Type II - Embroidered Components for Air Force Organizational/Provisional Flags, 3'Ø" x 4'Ø" in size.

Style 1 - Eagle and Clouds, Right
Style 2 - Eagle and Clouds, Left
Style 3 - USAF Scroll

Type III - Embroidered Components for Air Force Ceremonial/Positional flags 4'4" x 5'6" in size.

Style 1 - Eagle and Cloud, Right
Class 1 - Ultramarine Blue Base Cloth
Class 2 - White Base Cloth

Style 2 - Eagle and Cloud, Left
Class 1 - Ultramarine Blue Base Cloth
Class 2 - White Base Cloth

Style 3 - USAF Scroll
Style 4 - Thunderbolt, Wings and Lightning Darts

Type IV - Embroidered Components for Marine Corps Standard Flags

Style 1 - Eagle's Wing, Left
Style 2 - Eagle's Wing, Right
Style 3 - Eagle's Head, Body and Talons, Left
Style 4 - Eagle's Head, Body and Talons, Right
Style 5 - Globe, Land masses, Grid lines and Eagle's tail feathers.
Style 6 - Anchor, Top, Left
Style 7 - Anchor, Top, Right
Style 8 - Anchor, Bottom, Left
Style 9 - Anchor, Bottom, Right
Style 1Ø - Scroll, Top
Style 11 - Scroll, bottom with "United States Marine Corps".
Style 12 - Scroll, bottom with "United States Marine Corps Reserve".

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

CCC-C-476 - Cloth, Bunting, Nylon; and nylon and wool.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.

MILITARY

MIL-C-606 - Cloth, Banner, Rayon.

STANDRDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-191 - Textile, Test methods.
FED-STD-751 - Stitches, Seams and Stitchings.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-794 - Parts and Equipment, Procedures for Packaging of.

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

5-6-1 Base Drawing for Details of Eagle, Olive Branch and Arrows (Army)
5-6-1B Base Drawing, Master Layout for Cartoons (Army)
5-6-2 Base Drawing for Organizational Colors with Color Specifications (Army)
5-100-1 Air Force Organizational Flags
5-101-1 Coat of Arms, United States Air Force
5-101-1A Ceremonial Flag, United States Air Force
5-100-1, Sheet 2 - Base Drawing, USAF, Organizational Flags, Components on Base Cloth
5-101-1A, Sheet 2 - Ceremonial Flag, USAF, Components on Base Cloth

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5-MC-1, Sheet 1 - Organizational Flag for USMC
5-MC-1, Sheet 2 - Device for Organizational Flag, USMC
5-MC-1, Sheet 3 - Scroll for Organizational Flag, USMC
5-MC-1, Sheet 4 - Base Cloth for Components, Organizational Flag for USMC
5-MC-1, Sheet 5 - Base Cloth for Embroidered Scrolls, Organizational Flags for USMC

(Copies of specifications, standards, and other Governments documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

THE COLOR ASSOCIATION OF THE UNITED STATES

The Standard Color Reference of America, Tenth Edition.
United States Army Color Card, The Official Colors for Branches, Agencies, etc.
DOD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns for Embroidery and Ribbons, 1974.

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-D-3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race St., Philadelphia, PA 19103.) and
(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards) the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide samples. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), samples shall be furnished by the contracting officer to be used for guidance, information and as a standard for colorfastness. Variation from this specification may appear in the guide samples in which event the specification shall govern.

3.2 First article. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.4 and 6.4).

3.3 Materials. Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.3.1 Color. Unless otherwise specified, the color of the embroidery yarns shall be as shown on the applicable cartoon or drawing. The use of sulphur dyes is prohibited.

3.3.1.1 Matching. The color shall match the standard sample when viewed under filtered tungsten lamps which approximate artificial daylight having a correlated color temperature of 7000 plus or minus 500 K, with illumination of 100 plus or minus 20 foot candles, and shall be a good match to the sample under incandescent lamplight at 2300 plus or minus 100 K.

3.3.1.2 Colorfastness. When tested as specified in 4.6.1.1, the dyed embroidered yarn shall show good fastness to wet-dry cleaning, bleaching, or light, and fair fastness to laundering except that for black, blue, and red shades, the fastness to bleaching shall be not less than fair as defined in FED-STD-191.

3.3.2 Base cloth.

3.3.2.1 Embroidery yarn. Embroidery yarn for all flag components shall be 20/2 ss mercerized and gassed cotton, vat dyed unless rayon is specified on applicable cartoon. When rayon is specified, the yarn shall be a sami-dull continuous filament, regenerated cellulose type rayon, two-ply machine embroidery type yarn. The rayon yarn shall be 150, 100 or 75 denier as specified on the applicable cartoon.

3.3.2.2 Bobbin yarn. The bobbin yarn used in the Schiffli embroidery shall be a continuous multi-filament nylon or two-ply cotton yarn. The yarn shall be undyed.

3.3.2.3 Type I, style 1 and 2. The base cloth for type I, style 1 and 2 flag components shall be cotton or 50/50 or 65/35 cotton polyester blend, three up and one down left hand twill, 7.0 to 8.3 ounces per square yard, single ply warp and filling, with a breaking strength of not less than 150 lbs in the warp

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

and 80 lbs in the filling. The residual shrinkage shall be not more than 2 percent in either the warp or filling direction and the cloth shall have not less than fair colorfastness to laundering when tested as specified in 4.6.1.1.

3.3.2.4 Type I, styles 3 thru 9. The base cloth for type I, styles 3 thru 9 flag components shall be 100% filament nylon, plain weave, 1.5 to 2 ounces per square yard, single ply warp and filling, with breaking strength of 100 lbs in the warp and 80 lbs in the filling. The residual shrinkage shall be not less than 2 percent in either warp and filling direction. (see 4.6.1.1)

3.3.2.5 Type II and III. The base cloth for type II and III flag components shall be banner rayon conforming to MIL-C-606.

3.3.2.6 Type IV. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the base cloth for type IV flag components shall be a heavyweight nylon and conform to type I class B of CCC-C-476.

3.3.2.7 Color. The color of the base cloth shall be as follows:

Type, style and class	Base cloth
Type I	
Style 1 and 2	Brown Cable No. 80167
Style 3 thru 9	White Cable No. 80001
Type II	
Style 1 and 2	Royal Blue Cable No. 80173
Style 3	White Cable No. 80001
Type III	
Style 1 and 2, class 1	Royal Blue Cable No. 80173
Style 1 and 2, class 2	White Cable No. 80001
Style 3	White Cable No. 80001
Style 4	Brittany Blue Cable No. 80130
Type IV	
Style 1,2,3,4,6,7,8 and 9	Brown Cable No. 80167
Style 5	Silver Gray Cable No. 80139
Styles 10,11,12	White Cable No. 80001

3.3.3 Buckram. The buckram or backing material, where specified, shall be a light, open-weave, single ply fabric weighing 2.5 ounces (minimum) per square yard having a minimum thread count of 40 ends in the warp and 20 ends in the filling. The buckram shall have a minimum breaking strength of 30 pounds in the warp direction and 20 pounds in the filling direction. Testing shall be in accordance with 4.6.1.1.

3.4 Design. The design and color for the components shall be as shown on the original design drawing or applicable Government cartoon.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5 Construction. The insignia shall be embroidered on a Schiffli embroidery machine in accordance with this specification. When furnished by the Government the applicable cartoon shall form a part of this specification. Cartoons are furnished to indicate the placement of different types of stitches. The cartoon will normally indicate the number of under, cover and miscellaneous stitches to produce an insignia as well as a mandatory requirement for total minimum stitches. The manufacturer, at his discretion, may vary the under and cover stitches provided he meets the total minimum stitches required and produces a product equal to or better than, the standard or guide sample. The density of cover stitches may be increased in critical areas where defects may occur. All thread ends shall be trimmed.

3.5.1 Embroidery stitches. The embroidery stitches shall be of the type, length, number and density specified on the applicable Government cartoon. The total stitches specified on the cartoon are full stitches and constitute two revolutions or movements of the machine. Underlay stitches shown on the cartoon by numbers are 1/2 stitches (one movement of the machine) but are converted to full stitches on the tabular listing. Except where otherwise indicated in the cartoon, all letters shall be underlaid and formed with blatt stitches. When required by contract provisions, the contractor shall submit a sample for approval. When a contractor's sample has been specifically approved for appearance of the embroidery stitching prior to production, deliveries shall be in this respect equal to the approved sample.

3.5.1.1 Device stitches. Unless otherwise specified, device stitches shall be in accordance with the applicable Government cartoon with respect to spacing the rows, number of visible stitches and length and density of stitches. Translation of curvatures, letters and other device features shall be executed with embroidery stitching finished evenly to effect a clean outline. The placement of stitches shall be as required by the Government cartoon.

3.5.1.2 Underlay stitches. When underlay stitches are required, the number of stitches shall be as indicated on the cartoon. Where underlay is required in areas of design showing rows of stitches, the underlay stitches shall be inserted in a criss-cross pattern. In other areas requiring underlay, the underlay stitches shall be inserted in the direction most suitable for proper design execution.

3.5.1.3 Stiele stitches. The length and density of required stiele stitches shall be in accordance with the applicable Government cartoon. The stiele stitches shall be tightly drawn and well executed to produce a clear, sharp edging.

3.5.2 Stiffener. The use of buckram specified in 3.3.3 shall be permitted provided it does not protrude at any point beyond the outline of the embroidered components.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.5.3 Cutting. Embroidered components shall be cut in single units with base cloth extending from the embroidered edge as specified in applicable cartoon or drawing.

3.6 Tolerances. Unless otherwise specified, the overall measurements of the finished embroidered component shall be within a tolerance of plus or minus 1/8 inch of the required measurements. Where no tolerances are cited, design dimensions shall have a tolerance of plus or minus 1/32 inch.

3.7 Workmanship. The finished component shall be clean and well made and shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

4.1.2 Certificate of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in (applicable test method document or applicable paragraph(s) in the specification).

4.4 First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article sample shall be made on a completely finished insignia for all provisions of this specification applicable to the end product examination and tests.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.6 Quality assurance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105 except when otherwise specified hereafter.

4.6.1 Component and material inspection. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials as specified herein.

4.6.1.1 Testing of components. Components and materials shall be tested as specified in table II. The methods of testing specified in FED-STD-191 wherever applicable, and as specified herein shall be followed. The sample size for each characteristic of each component shall be as follows:

Lot size (unit)	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 to 22,000	3
22,001 to over	5

The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units of any component fail to meet the requirements in table II. The unit of expressing lot size and sample unit shall be as follows:

Component	Lot size expressed as	Sample size for testing
Buckram	Yard	1 linear yard full width
Embroidery yarn	pound	1 holder for every color
Bobbin yarn	pound	5 bobbins for dyed yarn 1 bobbin for natural yarn
Cloth,Cotton, polyester/cotton, nylon, rayon base cloth (as applicable)	yard	3-1/2 yards full width

When the data in the "#determ per s/u" and "Results reported as" columns are not specified in table II, they shall be as required in the referenced test method.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE II. Component tests.

Component	Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	#determ per s/u	Results reported as
Embroidery yarn	Material ident	3.3.2 1/	1500 or 1520	-	Pass or fail
	Ply	3.3.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail
	Denier and count	3.3.2	4021	1	To nearest denier
	Presence of Sulphur	3.3.1 1/	2020	1	Pass or fail
	Color	3.3.1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
	Colorfastness: wet-dry cleaning	3.3.1.2	5622	1	Pass or fail
Base cloth	Material ident	3.3.2	1/	-	-
	Weave	3.3.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail
	Weight	3.3.2	5041	5	Nearest 0.1 oz/sq
	Ply	3.3.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail
	Breaking strength:				
	Warp (lbs)	3.3.2	5100	5	Nearest 1 lb.
	Filling (lbs)	3.3.2	5100	5	Nearest 1 lb.
	Shrinkage:				
	Warp	3.3.2	5550	3	Nearest 0.1%
	Filling	3.3.2	5550	3	Nearest 0.1%
	Colorfastness to Laundering	3.3.2	5610	1	Pass or fail
Bobbin yarn	Material ident	3.3.2 1/	1200 & 1530	1 -	Pass or fail -
	Ply (when cotton yarn is used)	3.3.2	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Buckram	Weave	3.3.3	Visual	1	Pass or fail
	Weight	3.3.3	5041	5	Nearest 0.1 oz/sq yd
	Yarn count:				
	Warp	3.3.3	5050	5	Nearest whole number
	Filling	3.3.3	5050	5	Nearest whole number
	Breaking strength:				
	Warp (lbs)	3.3.3	5100	5	Nearest 1 lb.
	Filling (lbs)	3.3.3	5100	5	Nearest 1 lb.

1/ Unless otherwise specified a contractor's certification of compliance may be accepted as evidence of conformance.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6.2 Visual examination of the end item. Defects found during this examination shall be assigned from 1 to 3 demerit points, as prescribed in table IV, and all demerit points found shall be added accordingly. All defects shall be so scored, except where two or more classifications of table IV are applicable for a single location condition, in which case the highest point count applicable shall be scored. The lot size, sample size and sample unit shall be expressed in units of one finished insignia flag component. The sample size and maximum sum of points permitted shall be as shown in table III, expressed as maximum sum of points for 3 and 2 point defects combined, and for all defects combined. The lot shall be unacceptable if the sum of the point value of the examined sample exceeds the limits established in table III. Normal inspection distance for workmanship shall be at arm's length (16 to 22 inches). Examination for other defects may be determined at an inspection distance suitable for such examinations.

TABEL III. Maximum sums of points

Lot size	Sample	3 and 2 points combined	3, 2 and 1 points combined
(Regular inspection)			
Under 3200	125	25	35
3201 - 10,000	200	35	53
10,001 - 35,000	315	53	75
35,001 - 150,000	500	75	110
150,001 and up	800	110	150
(Tightened inspection)			
3201 - 10,000	200	30	45
10,001 - 35,000	315	45	68
35,001 - 150,000	500	68	103
150,001 and up	800	103	138

TABLE IV. Defects

Examine	Defect	Point count		
Base cloth	Other than specified	3	-	-
	Any splice, cut, hole or tear visible on face.	3	-	-
	Color shade not as specified	3	-	-
Backing	Buckram protrudes embroidered component. . . .	-	-	1
Construction (embroidery)	Embroidery yarn not an acceptable match . . .	3	-	-
	Background not as specified	3	-	-
General	Device not as specified	3	-	-
	Spacing of rows not in accordance with cartoon	-	2	-

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. Defects - continued.

Examine	Defect	Point count		
	Non-uniform embroidery stitch density	-	-	1
	Bobbin thread showing on face	-	2	-
	Tight tension-distorted surface of face side.	3	-	-
	Loose tension-loopy surface	-	*	-
	Traveling (walking) stitches on face of insignia	-	*	-
	Broken stitches or stitching incomplete (missing).	-	*	-
Design	Any departure from cartoon or drawing	3	-	-
	Design or device poorly defined, sharp outline lacking.	3	-	-
	Shift, device or outline misshaped.	-	*	-
	Device flat-underlay missing or not well rounded or prominent, underlay insufficient.	-	-	1
	Design not adequately covering base cloth, background, or underlay showing through (thin or uneven stitch density).	3	-	-
	Curvature or design features fuzzy, not clearly outlined	-	2	-
	Stiele stitches not firmly drawn to produce clearly defined rows or edges.	-	2	-
	Stiele stitch in borders device not as required by cartoon.	-	2	-
Workmanship	Kinked, bunched, tangled yarn on face	-	*	-
General	Broken, Scuffed, or cut yarns on face	-	*	-
	Spot, stain, stiffener, or foreign matter on face	-	-	1
	Two or more thread ends untrimmed	-	-	1
	More than two stumps longer than 1/16 inch. .	-	-	1
	Creased or folded, will not flatten by manual pressure	-	*	-
	Embroidery yarn not an acceptable match to other components.	3	-	-
Borders	Not uniform in width or unevenly trimmed. . .	-	2	-
(base cloth)	Free material between edge design and raw edge of material not as specified.	3	-	-
	Not cut in single units when required	3	-	-

*Defects designated by an (*) asterisk shall be classed as follows:
3 point defect when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability.
2 point defect when affecting appearance but not seriously.
1 point defect when affecting serviceability but not seriously.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.6.3 Examination for dimensions. Measurements shall be taken of all points, lines, areas, curves and spaces for which dimensions are specified in the drawing, including:

Border width
Device location Device dimension
Spaces and distances between intermediate points
Width of base cloth extending from component

The lot size shall be expressed in units of one embroidered component. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated component. Each measurement found to be outside of the specified tolerances shall be scored as a defect. The total defects found shall not exceed the maximum of the table in this paragraph. The sample shall be selected at random from among the units selected for visual examination. The tolerances for paragraph 3.6 or any other specific tolerances provided shall be applied. A 100 percent inspection shall be performed on all embroidered flag blank components. Components shall be rejected with more than three, 3-point defects or when any of the 3-point defects cannot be repaired.

Lot size	Sample size	No. of defects (Max)
Under 3200	5	0
3201 to 22,000	15	1
over 22,000	25	2

4.6.4 Inspection of packaging. An examination shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table V. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception it need not be sealed. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 defects for per hundred units.

TABLE V. Classification of preparation for delivery defects.

Examination	Defects
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE V. Classification of preparation for delivery defects - continued.

Examination	Defects
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as, incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers.
Weight	Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.6.4.1 Examination of count. An examination shall be made to determine that the number of insignia per bundle, box and shipping container is as required by section 5 of this specification. Table VI shall govern this examination.

TABLE VI. Examination of count.

Examine	Unit of product or lot expressed in units of	Sample size	
		#Units in lot	#Units selected
Unit Packaging			
a. Number of insignia per bundle	One bundle	Up to 300 301 - 500 501 - 800 801 - 1300 1301 & over	5 10 15 25 30
Intermediate packaging.			
b. Number of bundles.	One box	Up to 300 301 - 500 501 - 800 801 - 1300 1301 & over	5 10 15 25 30
Packing.			
c. Number of boxes per shipping container	One shipping container	Up to 3 4 to 6 7 & over	All 3 4

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The lot shall be unacceptable if any of the defects listed below are found:

a. Number of insignia per bundle. The average number of insignia per bundle is less than specified

b. Number of boxes per shipping container. The total number of insignia in a shipping container is less than the total indicated on outside container marking.

4.6.5 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization is in compliance with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

examine	defect
finished dimensions	length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be levels A, C or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Twenty embroidered flag components of one type, style, class shall be placed flat in a polyethylene bag and taped closed.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. No intermediate package is required; level C shall apply.

5.1.1.3 Level C. Insignia shall be preserved to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1.4 Commercial. Insignia shall be preserved in accordance with ASTM-D-3951.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, C or commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Insignia preserved, as specified, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class weather-resistant, type SF, grade V3s or type CF, grade V3c of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in conformance with the appendix of the appropriate container specification. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed the size and weight limitation of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. All insignia, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the container specification. The weight in each shipping container shall not exceed the weight and size limitation of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Insignia of one type, style, and class only, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed to the MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.2.4 Commercial. Insignia, preserved as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Palletization. Items packed as specified shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type 1A of MIL-STD-147. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance bonding means C, K and L, O or P. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. The pallet shall be 4-way, type I, class 1, style 1, size A, wood group I, II, III or IV of MIL-P-15011 or 4-way, type IV, V or VIII, class 1, style A, size 2, wood group I, II, III or IV, grade A of NN-P-71. Interlocking of loads shall be effected by reversing the pattern of each course. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall be approved by the contracting officer.

5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, unit packs, shipping containers, and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM-D-3951, as applicable.

5.4.1 Unit packaging. Unit packaging shall have the required information legibly printed or stamped in black on the bag across the center face, or on a white paper label inserted with in the bag so as to permit ready identification. The bag or label shall indicated the following:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Stock Number
Nomenclature
Quantity

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The insignia covered by this specification are intended to be used for appliquing on organizational and statutory flags used by the Department of Defense.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Type, style, class required (see 1.2).
c. Drawing number (see 2.1.2).
d. When a guide sample will not be furnished (see 3.1).
e. When a first article is not required (see 3.2).
f. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
g. When palletization is required (see 5.3).
h. Cartoon, when applicable (see 3.5).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item should be a first article sample or it may be a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory as specified in 4.4. The first article should consist of one completed insignia. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Invitations for bids should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.5 Supersession data. This specification includes, in part, the requirements of MIL-I-3037G dated 30 September 1981 and amendment 3 thereto dated 31 December 1982.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6.6 Cross-reference. Previous classifications listed in MIL-I-3037 have been changed to the new classifications indicated in 1.2 this specification. New items may be binned with or substituted for previous items.

Previous classification under MIL-I-3037	New classification under this specification
Material A, type VII	Type I
Material C, type I	Type I
Material D, type I	Type II
Material D, type II	Type III
Not previously classified	Type IV

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Schiffli
Embroidered
Insignia
Flags
Components
Ceremonial
Organizational
Provisional
Cartoon
Drawings

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11
Navy - NU

Review activities:
Air Force - 82,99
Navy - MC

User activities:
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

(Project No. 8455 - 0201)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

The Institute of Heraldry, US Army
Cameron Station, 5010 Duke Street
Alexandria, Virginia 22304-5050

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 12062 WASHINGTON D C

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Director
The Institute of Heraldry, US Army
ATTN: DAPC-PDH-T
Cameron Station, 5010 Duke Street
Alexandria, Virginia 22304-5050

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-I-14653	Insignia, Embroidered Flag Components, General Specification for

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-18T04:25Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.